

coming up with different policies to maintain the trend of upwards growth.

Ministry of Power had issued a clarification in 2018 stating that **charging EVs is considered a service, not a sale of electricity. This means that no licence is required to operate EV charging stations.** It also issued a policy to permit private charging at residences and offices where tariff for supply of electricity to EV charging stations shall not be more than the average cost of supply plus fifteen per cent.

Even though EV charging equipment is available in the market, investments are not possible without standardisation. Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) has notified general requirements for EV charging based on Combined Charging System (CCS) and Charge de Move (ChadeMo) charging standards.

The second phase of the scheme for Faster Adoption and Manufacturing of (Hybrid &) Electric Vehicles (FAME II), effective from April 1, 2019,

comes as a major transition over FAME I (2015). It will be used for upfront incentives on the purchase of EVs as well as support for the development of charging infrastructure. EVs eligible under this scheme can save 5.4 million tonnes of oil equivalent, over their lifetime worth of approximately ₹ 1720 billion, as stated by NITI Aayog.

Along with this, creation of Phased Manufacturing Programme (PMP) for localisation of the entire value chain has been approved.

When it comes to industry, usage of solar power as a fuel for EVs is being explored by companies in Mumbai and beyond. Even Indian Railways intends to allocate space for EV charging stations at their station parking lots. Public sector units are also getting involved in the development of charging stations.

Although FAME II specifications are useful, these put most currently-deployed EVs out of subsidy range. According to *autocapro.in*, Pankaj Tiwari, business development head

of Avan Motors, an EV startup, “As the government is aiming to achieve a sale of one million units of EVs in the next three years, it must also provide the people with continuous subsidies on the EV segment for a significant period of time. Success of this initiative will largely depend on how feasible and affordable the government manages to make the accessibility of EVs to the masses.”

Original equipment manufacturers and dealers can work together to increase understanding and awareness among consumers. Major advantages possible in this transformation are reduced air pollution, reduced oil imports and increased job opportunities. Aligning EV policies with each other and other relevant programmes such as National Clean Air Programme (NCAP), Smart Cities Mission and Urban Mobility Scheme will ensure flexibility in building a network of smart, sustainable and friendly cities.

—Ayushee Sharma

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DATA ANALYTICS:

“CONSTANT ANALYSIS Of Information To Generate Real-Time Insights ENHANCES The VALUE OF DATA”

- Data analytics makes it easier for business users to interact, share and collaborate with data—which is the very essence of data literacy—regardless of where or how they work. Nish Patel, senior director, Qlik, discusses how data analytics can help optimise work and improve employee efficiency, in an interaction with Deepshikha Shukla

Q. Why are data literacy skills important to render efficiency of employees?

A. Data literacy is not just about improving employee efficiency and productivity; it is also about helping them become more effective and add greater value to the organisation’s business operations. As per Qlik’s Data Literacy Index, organisations can realise the enterprise value of up to US\$ 534 million with higher corporate

data literacy (CDL). Organisations with higher CDL also typically witness better performance across various KPIs such as gross margin, return-on-sales, return-on-equity, return-on-assets, etc.

Data literate employees can read, work with, analyse and argue with the data available to them. This essentially means that they can ask better questions to get better answers. This helps them build a more accurate knowledge base, make better decisions

and communicate their message more effectively. It is hardly surprising, then, that **data literate employees are found to be more confident in their abilities, perform better and have higher credibility at the workplace.**

Q. How can maximum benefits be retrieved from huge piles of data?

A. Extracting benefits from huge piles of data depends on the intent of the person asking questions of